

Glossary of real estate terms

These are some of the main phrases you will read in a contract of sale, or hear a real estate agent, property solicitor or conveyancer use in their dealings with you. If you're embarking on a property purchase, grab the contract, a glass of wine and a highlighter, and get familiar with these terms.

Acceleration clause – A part of a mortgage document that requires the immediate repayment of the entire balance if there is a breach, such as missed payments.

Adjustments – The allocation of rates, taxes, body corporate fees, rent, insurances, etc., up to the date of settlement.

Agents in conjunction – Two or more real estate agents employed by a vendor to sell their home. A listing will advise if there is a conjunction agency.

Appreciation – An increase in value.

Bid – A verbal or written offer to purchase.

Body corporate – A group of owners within an apartment block, responsible for managing the upkeep of shared areas and protecting the owners' interests.

Building Code of Australia (BCA) – Sets the minimum standards for building design and construction.

Building inspector – An authorised person who is responsible for checking buildings during and after construction, and who makes sure that they comply with controls.